# उत्सवाः

# My Sanskrit Festival Workbook

## संस्कृत-उत्सव-अभ्यास-पुस्तिका

Dīpāvalī · Gaṇeśa Caturthī · Navarātri · Vijayadaśamī · Oṇam · Makara Saṅkrānti · Mahāśivarātri · Holi · Rāma Navamī · Rakṣābandhana · Janmāṣṭamī · Festive adornment

Name / नाम: _____



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# How to use · कथं प्रयोक्तव्यम्

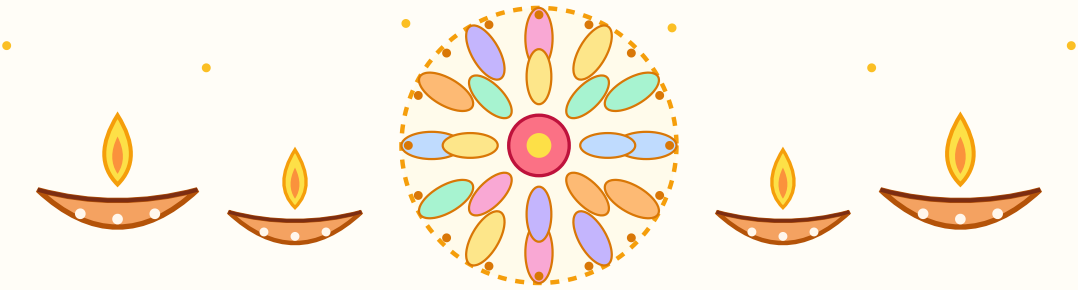
1. Each festival has two pages: words, then a śloka and small exercises.
2. Read each word aloud: first the Devanagari, then the sound (transliteration).
3. Learn the śloka slowly, one line a day, and read its meaning.
4. Do the exercises, then try the mixed quiz and check the answer key.
5. Use the greetings page to wish your family and friends in Sanskrit!

> Tip: words ending in -ḥ (ः) or -m (म्) are the usual naming forms. Some festival names here are given in Roman letters in Malayalam too, so you can recognise them.

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# Dīpāvalī · दीपावली



Dīpāvalī means “a row of lamps”. Families clean their homes, draw raṅgavallī at the door, light lamps on the new-moon night of Kārtika, worship Lakṣmī and share sweets. It celebrates light over darkness.

## Festival words · शब्दाः

| Sanskrit | Sound | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| दीपः | dīpaḥ | lamp |
| दीपावली | dīpāvalī | row of lamps |
| प्रकाशः | prakāśaḥ | light |
| तैलम् | tailam | oil |
| वर्तिका | vartikā | wick |
| लक्ष्मीपूजा | lakṣmīpūjā | worship of Lakṣmī |
| रङ्गवल्ली | raṅgavallī | rangoli (coloured floor design) |
| मिष्टान्नम् | miṣṭānnam | sweets |
| नूतनवस्त्रम् | nūtanavastram | new clothes |
| अमावास्या | amāvāsyā | new-moon night |

# Dīpāvalī: śloka & practice

शुभं करोति कल्याणम् आरोग्यं धनसम्पदः ।
शत्रुबुद्धिविनाशाय दीपज्योतिर्नमोऽस्तु ते ॥



śubhaṃ karoti kalyāṇam ārogyaṃ dhanasampadaḥ |
śatrubuddhivināśāya dīpajyotir namo’stu te ||

**Meaning:** Salutations to you, light of the lamp, who bring goodness, well-being, health and wealth, and who remove hostile thoughts.

तमसो मा ज्योतिर्गमय । (tamaso mā jyotir gamaya: Lead me from darkness to light.)

### 1. Write the meaning

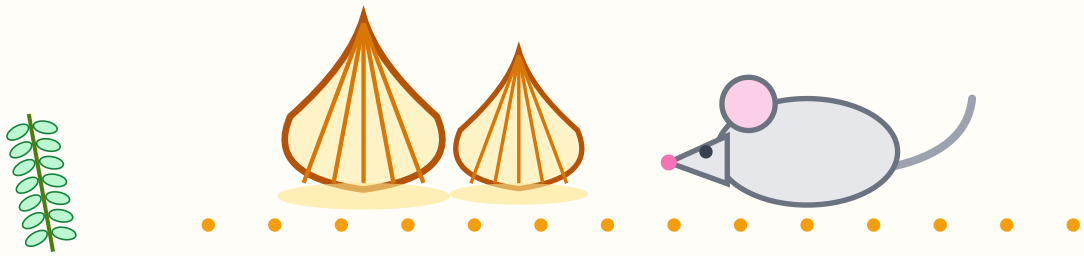
1. दीपः _____
2. तैलम् _____
3. रङ्गवल्ली _____

### 2. Write in Sanskrit

4. row of lamps _____
5. new-moon night _____

### 3. Copy the first line

# Gaṇeśa Caturthī · गणेशचतुर्थी



On the fourth day (caturthī) of the bright half of Bhādrapada, families welcome Gaṇeśa home, offer modakas and dūrvā grass, sing together and, at the end, carry the image for visarjana (immersion).

## Festival words · शब्दाः

| Sanskrit | Sound | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| गणेशः | gaṇeśaḥ | Gaṇeśa |
| गणपतिः | gaṇapatiḥ | lord of the gaṇas |
| चतुर्थी | caturthī | the fourth day |
| मोदकः | modakaḥ | modaka (sweet dumpling) |
| मूषकः | mūṣakaḥ | mouse (Gaṇeśa's vehicle) |
| एकदन्तः | ekadantaḥ | the one-tusked one |
| लम्बोदरः | lambodaraḥ | the big-bellied one |
| विघ्नहर्ता | vighnahartā | remover of obstacles |
| दूर्वा | dūrvā | dūrvā grass |
| विसर्जनम् | visarjanam | immersion |

# Gaṇeśa Caturthī: śloka & practice

वक्रतुण्ड महाकाय सूर्यकोटिसमप्रभ ।
निर्विघ्नं कुरु मे देव सर्वकार्येषु सर्वदा ॥



vakratuṇḍa mahākāya sūryakoṭisamaprabha |
nirvighnaṃ kuru me deva sarvakāryeṣu sarvadā ||

**Meaning:** O Lord with the curved trunk and mighty body, shining like a crore suns, please make all my work free of obstacles, always.

### 1. Write the meaning

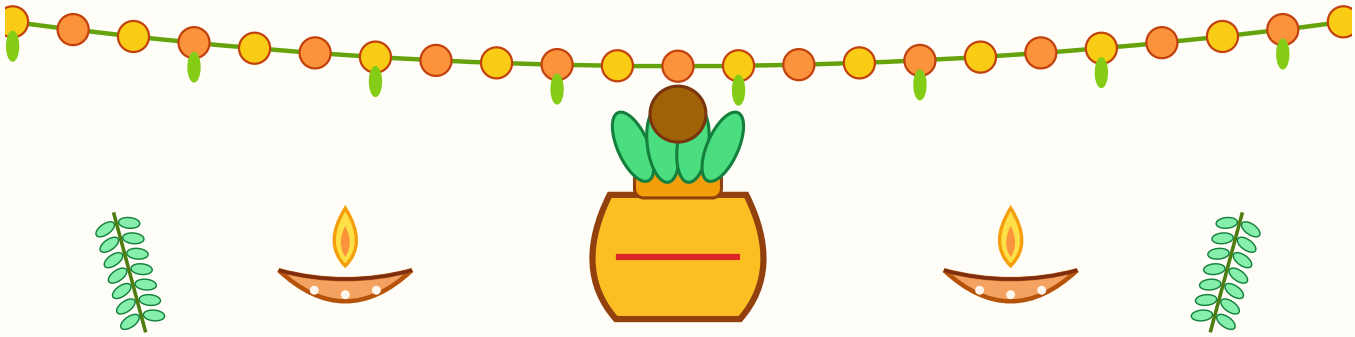
1. गणेशः _____
2. मोदकः _____
3. लम्बोदरः _____

### 2. Write in Sanskrit

4. lord of the gaṇas _____
5. immersion _____

### 3. Copy the first line

# Navarātri · नवरात्रिः



For nine nights (Navarātri) the Devī is worshipped as Durgā, Lakṣmī and Sarasvatī. A kalaśa is set up on the first day, many people keep a fast, young girls are honoured (kanyā-pūjā), and in many places people dance garbā. On the last days books and tools are honoured.

## Festival words · शब्दाः

| Sanskrit | Sound | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| नवरात्रिः | navarātriḥ | nine nights |
| दुर्गा | durgā | Durgā |
| लक्ष्मीः | lakṣmīḥ | Lakṣmī |
| सरस्वती | sarasvatī | Sarasvatī |
| घटस्थापना | ghaṭasthāpanā | setting up the sacred pot (kalaśa) |
| कलशः | kalaśaḥ | sacred pot |
| उपवासः | upavāsaḥ | fasting |
| कन्यापूजा | kanyāpūjā | honouring young girls |
| महिषासुरमर्दिनी | mahiṣāsuramardinī | she who defeated Mahiṣāsura |
| गरबा | garbā | circle dance (Gujarati word, not Sanskrit) |

# Navarātri: śloka & practice

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु शक्तिरूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै नमस्तस्यै नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥





yā devī sarvabhūteṣu śaktirūpeṇa saṃsthitā |
namas tasyai namas tasyai namas tasyai namo namaḥ ||

**Meaning:** To the Goddess who lives in all beings as strength (śakti): salutations to her, again and again.

### 1. Write the meaning

1. नवरात्रिः _____
2. सरस्वती _____
3. उपवासः _____

### 2. Write in Sanskrit

4. Durgā _____
5. circle dance (Gujarati word, not Sanskrit) _____

### 3. Copy the first line

# Dasarā · Vijayadaśamī · विजयदशमी



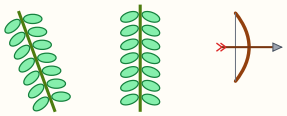
The tenth day after Navarātri is Vijayadaśamī, the day of victory. It remembers Rāma's victory over Rāvaṇa and the Devī's victory over Mahiṣāsura. In the north, effigies of Rāvaṇa are burnt after the Rāmlīlā; elsewhere tools and books are honoured (āyudha-pūjā), people exchange śamī leaves, cross the village border (sīmollaṅghana) and children start learning (vidyārambha).

## Festival words · शब्दाः

| Sanskrit | Sound | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| विजयदशमी | vijayadaśamī | the tenth day of victory |
| दशहरा | daśaharā | Dasarā (popular name, from Hindi) |
| विजयः | vijayaḥ | victory |
| रावणः | rāvaṇaḥ | Rāvaṇa |
| रावणदहनम् | rāvaṇadahanam | burning of Rāvaṇa's effigy |
| शमीवृक्षः | śamīvṛkṣaḥ | śamī tree |
| आयुधपूजा | āyudhapūjā | worship of tools and weapons |
| सीमोल्लङ्घनम् | sīmollaṅghanam | crossing the border |
| अपराजिता | aparājitā | the unconquered Devī |
| विद्यारम्भः | vidyārambhaḥ | beginning of learning |

# Dasarā · Vijayadaśamī: śloka & practice

शमी शमयते पापं शमी शत्रुविनाशिनी ।
अर्जुनस्य धनुर्धारी रामस्य प्रियदर्शिनी ॥



śamī śamayate pāpaṃ śamī śatruvināśinī |
arjunasya dhanurdhārī rāmasya priyadarśinī ||

**Meaning:** The śamī tree calms wrong-doing and removes enemies; it held Arjuna's bow and was dear to Rāma's eyes. (Recited at śamī-pūjā on Vijayadaśamī.)

### 1. Write the meaning

1. विजयदशमी _____
2. रावणः _____
3. आयुधपूजा _____

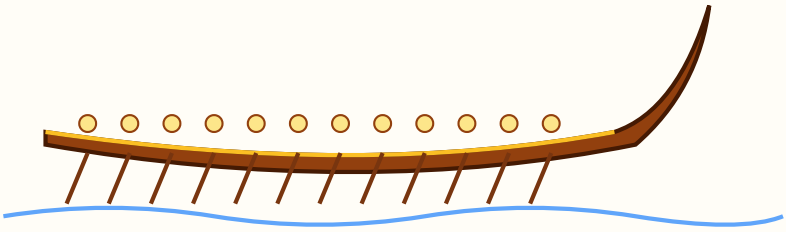
### 2. Write in Sanskrit

4. Dasarā (popular name, from Hindi) _____
5. beginning of learning _____

### 3. Copy the first line

# Oṇam · ओणम्





Oṇam is Kerala's harvest festival in the month of Chingam, remembering the good king Mahābali and Vāmana. Homes make flower carpets (pookkalam), families share a big feast on banana leaves (sadya), and there are boat races (vallam kali) and swings (oonjal). The main day, Thiruvonam, falls on the Śravaṇa star.

## Festival words · शब्दाः

| Sanskrit | Sound | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| श्रवणम् | śravaṇam | Śravaṇa star (Thiruvonam day) |
| महाबलिः | mahābaliḥ | King Mahābali |
| वामनः | vāmanaḥ | Vāmana |
| पुष्परङ्गवल्ली | puṣparaṅgavallī | flower carpet (Malayalam: pookkalam) |
| भोजनम् | bhojanam | feast, meal (Malayalam: sadya) |
| कदलीपत्रम् | kadalīpatram | banana leaf |
| नौकास्पर्धा | naukāspardhā | boat race (Malayalam: vallam kali) |
| दोला | dolā | swing (Malayalam: oonjal) |
| उत्सवः | utsavaḥ | festival |
| केरलम् | keralam | Kerala |

# Oṇam: śloka & practice

सर्वे भवन्तु सुखिनः सर्वे सन्तु निरामयाः ।
सर्वे भद्राणि पश्यन्तु मा कश्चिद् दुःखभाग्भवेत् ॥



sarve bhavantu sukhinaḥ sarve santu nirāmayāḥ |
sarve bhadrāṇi paśyantu mā kaścid duḥkhabhāg bhavet ||

**Meaning:** May all be happy, may all be free from illness, may all see good things, may no one suffer. (Oṇam remembers a time when everyone was equal and happy.)

### 1. Write the meaning

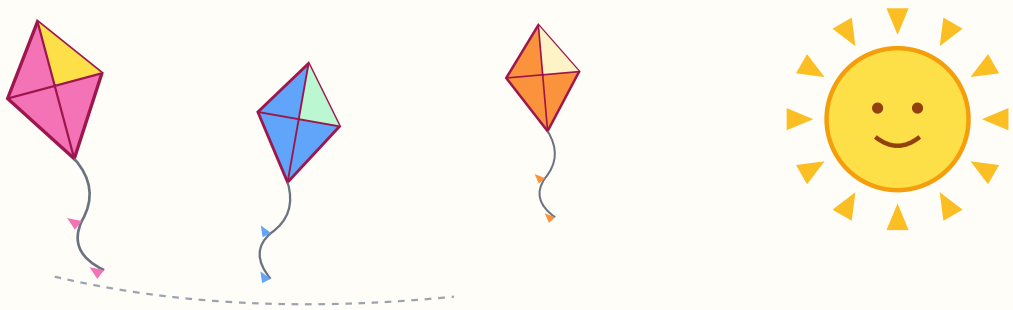
1. श्रवणम् _____
2. पुष्परङ्गवल्ली _____
3. नौकास्पर्धा _____

### 2. Write in Sanskrit

4. King Mahābali _____
5. Kerala _____

### 3. Copy the first line

# Makara Saṅkrānti · मकरसङ्क्रान्तिः



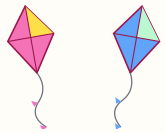
When the sun enters Makara (Capricorn) in mid-January, its northward course (uttarāyaṇa) is celebrated. People take a holy bath, give gifts, fly kites and share sesame and jaggery sweets. It is a harvest festival with many regional names.

## Festival words · शब्दाः

| Sanskrit | Sound | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| मकरसङ्क्रान्तिः | makarasaṅkrāntiḥ | sun entering Makara |
| सूर्यः | sūryaḥ | sun |
| उत्तरायणम् | uttarāyaṇam | the sun's northward course |
| तिलः | tilaḥ | sesame |
| गुडः | guḍaḥ | jaggery |
| तिलगुडम् | tilaguḍam | sesame-jaggery sweet |
| पतङ्गः | pataṅgaḥ | kite |
| दानम् | dānam | giving, gift |
| स्नानम् | snānam | bath |
| धान्यम् | dhānyam | grain, harvest |

# Makara Saṅkrānti: śloka & practice

ॐ मित्राय नमः । ॐ रवये नमः । ॐ सूर्याय नमः ।



oṃ mitrāya namaḥ | oṃ ravaye namaḥ | oṃ sūryāya namaḥ |

**Meaning:** Salutations to the friend of all, to the shining one, to the sun. (The first three Sūrya-namaskāra names.)

तिलगुडं गृहाण, मधुरं वद । (tilaguḍaṃ gṛhāṇa, madhuraṃ vada: Take sesame-jaggery, speak sweetly.)

### 1. Write the meaning

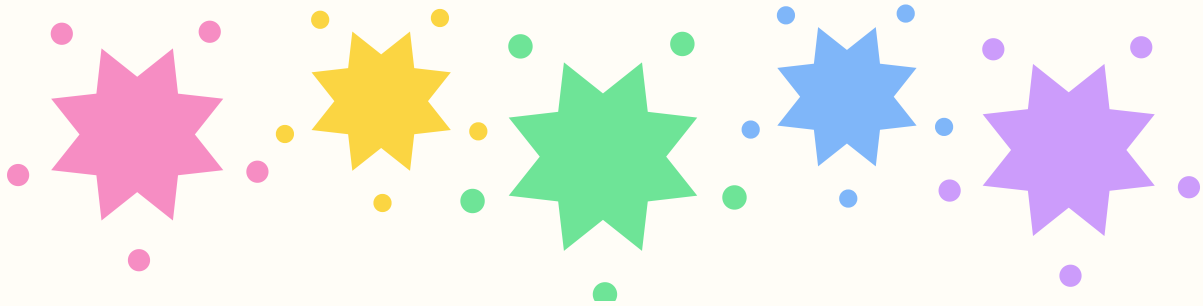
1. मकरसङ्क्रान्तिः _____
2. तिलः _____
3. पतङ्गः _____

### 2. Write in Sanskrit

4. sun _____
5. grain, harvest _____

### 3. Copy the first line

# Holi · होली



Holi welcomes spring on the full moon of Phālguna. On the night before, the Holikā fire recalls how young Prahlāda was protected. Next day everyone plays with colours and shares sweets.

## Festival words · शब्दाः

| Sanskrit | Sound | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| होलिका | holikā | Holikā (the bonfire night) |
| प्रह्लादः | prahlādaḥ | Prahlāda |
| वसन्तः | vasantaḥ | spring |
| फाल्गुनः | phālgunaḥ | month of Phālguna |
| पूर्णिमा | pūrṇimā | full-moon day |
| रङ्गः | raṅgaḥ | colour |
| जलम् | jalam | water |
| हर्षः | harṣaḥ | joy |
| मित्रम् | mitram | friend |

# Holi: śloka & practice

असतो मा सद्गमय । तमसो मा ज्योतिर्गमय ।
मृत्योर्मा अमृतं गमय ॥



asato mā sad gamaya | tamaso mā jyotir gamaya |
mṛtyor mā amṛtaṃ gamaya ||

**Meaning:** Lead me from the unreal to the real, from darkness to light, from death to immortality. (Bṛhadāraṇyaka Upaniṣad 1.3.28)

## 1. Write the meaning

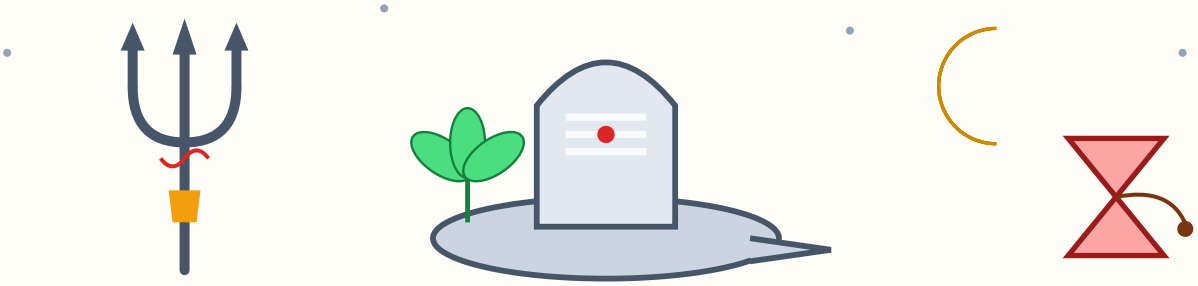
1. होलिका _____
2. फाल्गुनः _____
3. जलम् _____

## 2. Write in Sanskrit

4. Prahlāda _____
5. friend _____

## 3. Copy the first line

# Mahāśivarātri · महाशिवरात्रिः



Mahāśivarātri, the great night of Śiva, falls on the fourteenth night of the dark fortnight of Māgha or Phālguna (February–March). Devotees fast, stay awake through the night (jāgaraṇa), offer water, milk and bilva leaves on the liṅga, and chant ॐ नमः शिवाय.

## Festival words · शब्दाः

| Sanskrit | Sound | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| शिवः | śivaḥ | Śiva |
| रात्रिः | rātriḥ | night |
| लिङ्गम् | liṅgam | the liṅga (Śiva's symbol) |
| बिल्वपत्रम् | bilvapatram | bilva leaf |
| त्रिशूलम् | triśūlam | trident |
| अर्धचन्द्रः | ardhacandraḥ | crescent moon |
| डमरुः | ḍamaruḥ | small hand drum |
| नन्दी | nandī | Nandī the bull |
| अभिषेकः | abhiṣekaḥ | pouring water or milk in worship |
| जागरणम् | jāgaraṇam | staying awake |

# Mahāśivarātri: śloka & practice

कर्पूरगौरं करुणावतारं संसारसारं भुजगेन्द्रहारम् ।
सदा वसन्तं हृदयारविन्दे भवं भवानीसहितं नमामि ॥



karpūragauraṃ karuṇāvatāraṃ saṃsārasāraṃ bhujagendrahāram |
sadā vasantaṃ hṛdayāravinde bhavaṃ bhavānīsahitaṃ namāmi ||

**Meaning:** I bow to Bhava (Śiva) together with Bhavānī: white as camphor, compassion in form, the essence of the world, wearing the king of serpents as a garland, always living in the lotus of the heart.

ॐ नमः शिवाय । (oṃ namaḥ śivāya: Salutations to Śiva.)

### 1. Write the meaning

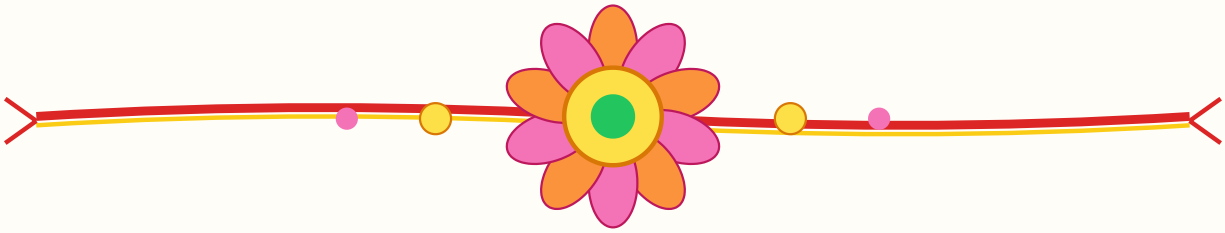
1. शिवः _____
2. बिल्वपत्रम् _____
3. डमरुः _____

### 2. Write in Sanskrit

4. night _____
5. staying awake _____

### 3. Copy the first line

# Rakṣābandhana · रक्षाबन्धनम्



On the full moon of Śrāvaṇa, a sister ties a rakṣā (protective thread) on her brother’s wrist and puts a tilaka; the brother promises to protect her, and they share sweets and gifts.

## Festival words · शब्दाः

| Sanskrit | Sound | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| रक्षाबन्धनम् | rakṣābandhanam | tying of the protective thread |
| रक्षा | rakṣā | protection |
| सूत्रम् | sūtram | thread |
| भ्राता | bhrātā | brother |
| भगिनी | bhaginī | sister |
| तिलकम् | tilakam | mark on the forehead |
| श्रावणः | śrāvaṇaḥ | month of Śrāvaṇa |
| उपहारः | upahāraḥ | gift |

# Rakṣābandhana: śloka & practice

येन बद्धो बली राजा दानवेन्द्रो महाबलः ।
तेन त्वां प्रतिबध्नामि रक्षे मा चल मा चल ॥

yena baddho balī rājā dānavendro mahābalaḥ |
tena tvāṃ pratibadhnāmi rakṣe mā cala mā cala ||

**Meaning:** With the thread that bound the mighty King Bali, I tie you. O rakṣā, stay firm, do not slip away.

### 1. Write the meaning

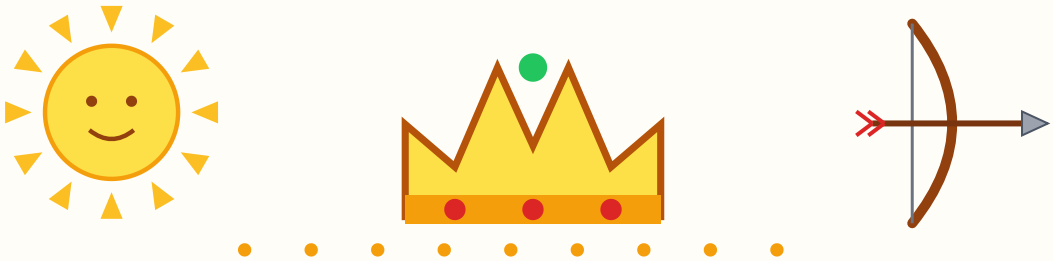
1. रक्षाबन्धनम् _____
2. भ्राता _____
3. श्रावणः _____

### 2. Write in Sanskrit

4. protection _____
5. gift _____

### 3. Copy the first line

# Rāma Navamī · रामनवमी



Rāma Navamī celebrates the birth of Śrī Rāma on the ninth day (navamī) of the bright fortnight of Caitra, at noon. People read the Rāmāyaṇa, sing bhajans, decorate cradles and share pānaka (a jaggery drink) and buttermilk.

## Festival words · शब्दाः

| Sanskrit | Sound | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| रामः | rāmaḥ | Rāma |
| नवमी | navamī | the ninth day |
| अयोध्या | ayodhyā | Ayodhyā |
| दशरथः | daśarathaḥ | King Daśaratha |
| कौसल्या | kausalyā | Queen Kausalyā |
| सीता | sītā | Sītā |
| लक्ष्मणः | lakṣmaṇaḥ | Lakṣmaṇa |
| हनुमान् | hanumān | Hanumān |
| धनुः | dhanuḥ | bow |
| रामायणम् | rāmāyaṇam | the Rāmāyaṇa |

# Rāma Navamī: śloka & practice

श्रीराम राम रामेति रमे रामे मनोरमे ।
सहस्रनाम तत्तुल्यं रामनाम वरानने ॥





śrīrāma rāma rāmeti rame rāme manorame |
sahasranāma tattulyaṃ rāmanāma varānane ||

**Meaning:** (Śiva to Pārvatī) Chanting “Śrī Rāma, Rāma, Rāma”, I delight in the delightful Rāma. O lovely one, the name of Rāma is equal to the thousand names.

### 1. Write the meaning

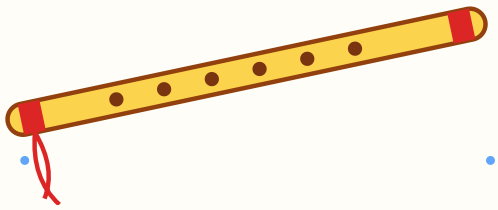
1. रामः _____
2. दशरथः _____
3. लक्ष्मणः _____

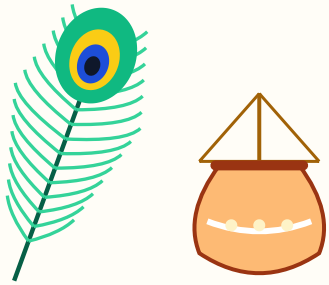
### 2. Write in Sanskrit

4. the ninth day _____
5. the Rāmāyaṇa _____

### 3. Copy the first line

# Kṛṣṇa Janmāṣṭamī · कृष्णजन्माष्टमी





Janmāṣṭamī celebrates the birth of Kṛṣṇa at midnight on the eighth day (aṣṭamī) of the dark fortnight, in Śrāvaṇa or Bhādrapada depending on the calendar. Homes and temples sing bhajans, babies' cradles are decorated, and in Maharashtra young people form human towers to break the curd pot (dahi-handi).

## Festival words · शब्दाः

| Sanskrit | Sound | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| कृष्णः | kṛṣṇaḥ | Kṛṣṇa |
| जन्माष्टमी | janmāṣṭamī | birth on the eighth day |
| वेणुः | veṇuḥ | flute |
| मुरली | muralī | flute |
| मयूरपिच्छम् | mayūrapiccham | peacock feather |
| दधि | dadhi | curd |
| नवनीतम् | navanītam | fresh butter |
| दधिभाण्डम् | dadhibhāṇḍam | curd pot (popular name: dahi-handi, from Marathi/Hindi) |
| गोपालः | gopālaḥ | cowherd |
| मध्यरात्रिः | madhyarātriḥ | midnight |

# Kṛṣṇa Janmāṣṭamī: śloka & practice

वसुदेवसुतं देवं कंसचाणूरमर्दनम् ।
देवकीपरमानन्दं कृष्णं वन्दे जगद्गुरुम् ॥





vasudevasutaṃ devaṃ kaṃsacāṇūramardanam |
devakīparamānandaṃ kṛṣṇaṃ vande jagadgurum ||

**Meaning:** I bow to Kṛṣṇa, the teacher of the world: son of Vasudeva, who overcame Kaṃsa and Cāṇūra, the greatest joy of Devakī.

### 1. Write the meaning

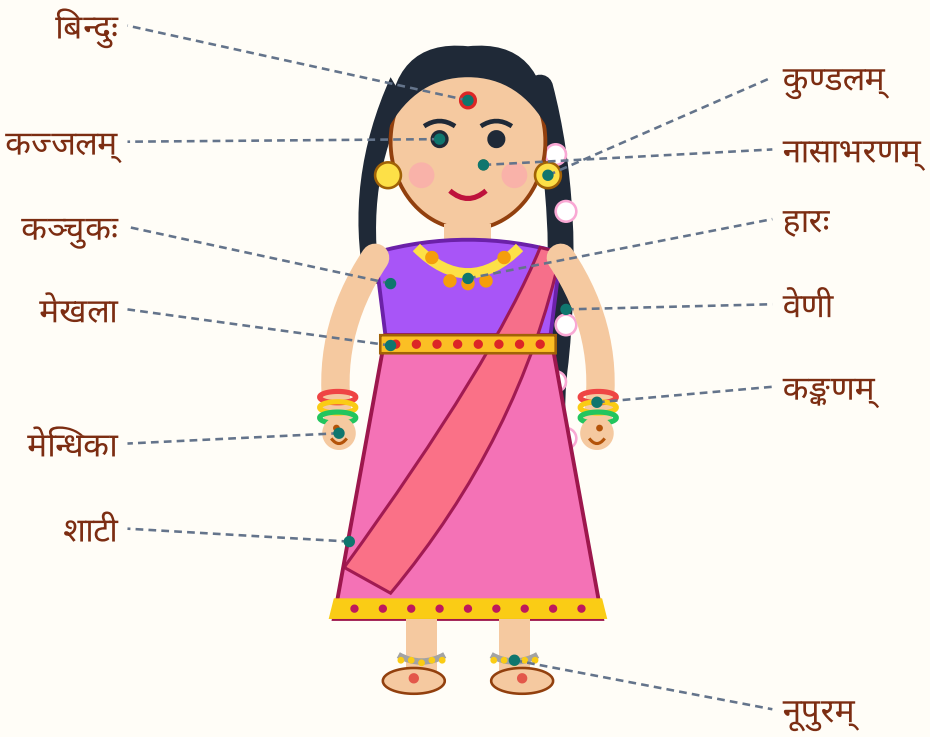
1. कृष्णः _____
2. मुरली _____
3. नवनीतम् _____

### 2. Write in Sanskrit

4. birth on the eighth day _____
5. midnight _____

### 3. Copy the first line

# Festive adornment · शृङ्गारः · अलङ्कारः




On festival days girls and women dress in their best: a bright शाटी, flowers in the वेणी, a बिन्दुः on the forehead and jingling नूपुराणि. Each ornament has a lovely Sanskrit name.

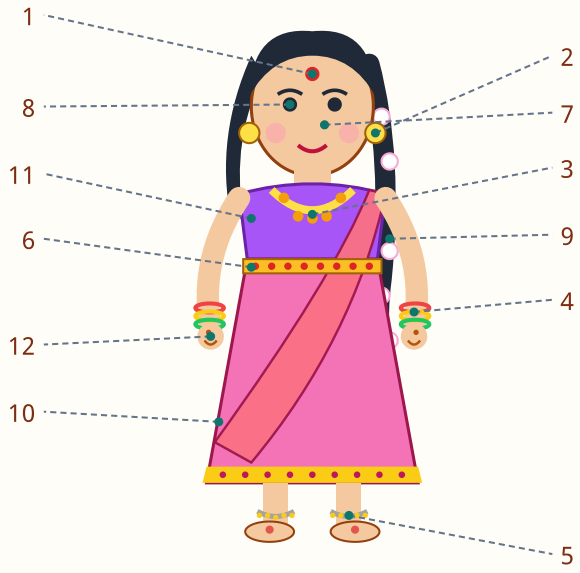
| Sanskrit | Sound | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| शाटी | śāṭī | sari (also शाटिका) |
| कञ्चुकः | kañcukaḥ | bodice, blouse |
| चोली | colī | blouse (Hindi word; Sanskrit चोलः / कञ्चुकः) |
| बिन्दुः | binduḥ | dot on the forehead (bindi) |
| तिलकम् | tilakam | mark on the forehead |
| कज्जलम् | kajjalam | kohl, kājal |
| कुण्डलम् | kuṇḍalam | earring |
| नासाभरणम् | nāsābharaṇam | nose ornament |
| हारः | hāraḥ | necklace |

# Adornment words · अलङ्काराः

| Sanskrit | Sound | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| कङ्कणम् | kaṅkaṇam | bracelet, bangle |
| वलयम् | valayam | bangle |
| अङ्गुलीयकम् | aṅgulīyakam | finger ring |
| मेखला | mekhalā | waist belt, girdle |
| नूपुरम् | nūpuram | anklet |
| मेन्धिका | mendhikā | henna, mehendī (mehendī is the Hindi word) |
| वेणी | veṇī | braid |
| पुष्पमाला | puṣpamālā | flower garland |
| माला · स्रक् | mālā · srak | garland |
| जपमाला | japamālā | prayer beads |
| रङ्गवल्ली | raṅgavallī | rangoli |
| तोरणम् | toraṇam | door garland, festive arch |

Words marked “Hindi word” are modern names; the Sanskrit word is given beside them.

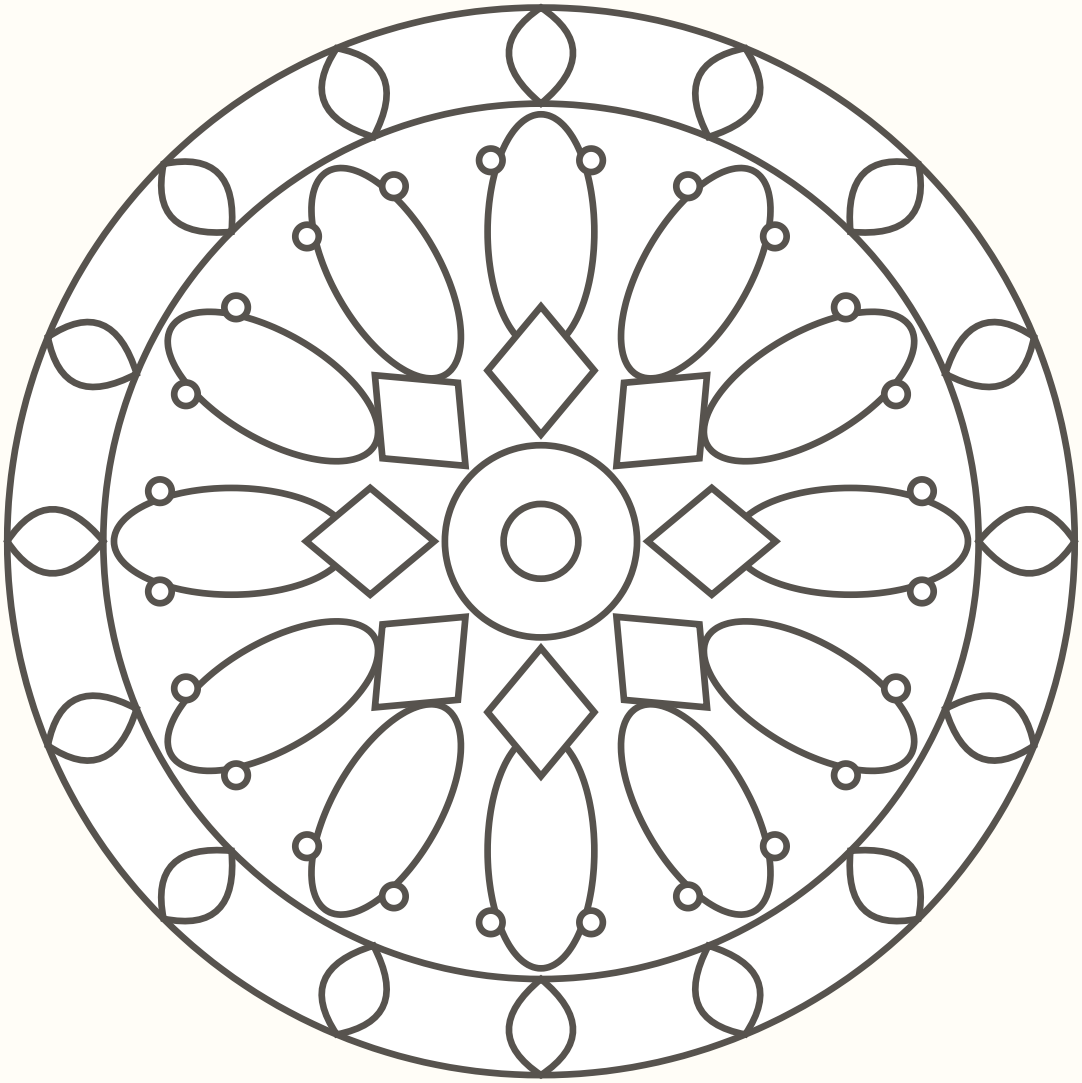
## Label the picture · चित्रे नामानि लिखत




1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____

# Colour the rangoli · रङ्गवल्लीं रञ्जयत

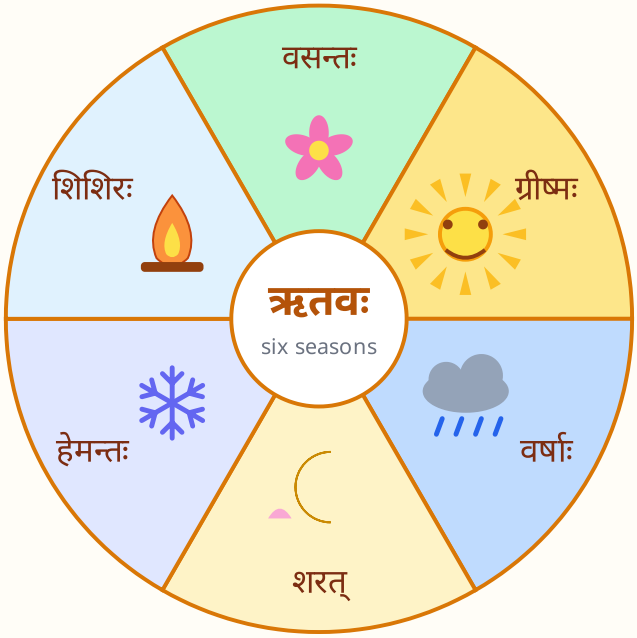
Colour the rangoli and the toraṇa with your favourite colours. Write a colour word (रक्तः, पीतः, हरितः, नीलः …) beside each ring.



## Write the Sanskrit word

1. door garland _____ · 2. flower garland _____ · 3. anklet _____

# The six seasons · षड् ऋतवः




The Indian year has six seasons (ṛtu, ऋतु), each two lunar months long. The Gregorian months are approximate, because lunar months shift a little every year.

| Season | Sound · meaning | Lunar months | About |
|---|---|---|---|
| वसन्तः | vasantaḥ<br>spring | चैत्रः, वैशाखः<br>Caitra, Vaiśākha | mid-March – mid-May |
| ग्रीष्मः | grīṣmaḥ<br>summer | ज्येष्ठः, आषाढः<br>Jyeṣṭha, Āṣāḍha | mid-May – mid-July |
| वर्षाः | varṣāḥ<br>rainy season | श्रावणः, भाद्रपदः<br>Śrāvaṇa, Bhādrapada | mid-July – mid-September |
| शरत् | śarat<br>autumn | आश्विनः, कार्तिकः<br>Āśvina, Kārtika | mid-September – mid-November |
| हेमन्तः | hemantaḥ<br>early winter | मार्गशीर्षः, पौषः<br>Mārgaśīrṣa, Pauṣa | mid-November – mid-January |
| शिशिरः | śiśiraḥ<br>late winter | माघः, फाल्गुनः<br>Māgha, Phālguna | mid-January – mid-March |

# Seasons: festivals & nature words

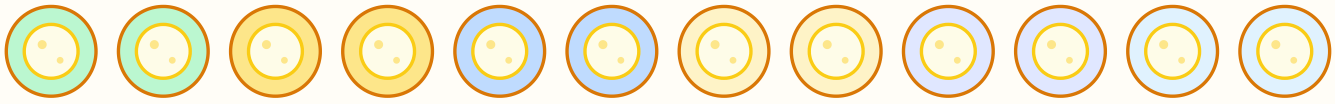
| Season | Festivals | Nature words |
|---|---|---|
| वसन्तः | Ugādi / Gudi Padwa, Rāma Navamī | पुष्पम् (flower), कोकिलः (cuckoo), आम्रः (mango tree) |
| ग्रीष्मः | Ratha Yātrā | तापः (heat), सूर्यः (sun), छाया (shade) |
| वर्षाः | Rakṣābandhana, Gaṇeśa Caturthī, Oṇam | मेघः (cloud), वृष्टिः (rain), मयूरः (peacock), मण्डूकः (frog) |
| शरत् | Navarātri, Vijayadaśamī, Dīpāvalī | चन्द्रः (moon), कमलम् (lotus), आकाशम् (sky) |
| हेमन्तः | Gītā Jayantī | हिमम् (frost, snow), धान्यम् (grain, harvest) |
| शिशिरः | Makara Saṅkrānti, Vasanta Pañcamī, Mahāśivarātri, Holi | शीतम् (cold), अग्निः (fire), वायुः (wind) |

Holi falls on the full moon of Phālguna, at the end of Śiśira, welcoming Vasanta. Makara Saṅkrānti (about 14 January) begins the solar Śiśira.

**Exercise · ऋतवः**

1. श्रावणः and भाद्रपदः belong to _____ .
2. Dīpāvalī comes in _____ .
3. The season of cuckoos and mango blossoms is _____ .
4. शीतम् (cold) is a word for _____ .
5. Write the six seasons in order: _____

# The twelve months · मासाः




Each lunar month is named after the nakṣatra (star) near the full moon. Gregorian months are approximate. ★ = has its own section in this book.

| Month | Sound | About | Ṛtu | Main festival |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| चैत्रः | caitraḥ | Mar – Apr | वसन्तः | Ugādi / Gudi Padwa, Rāma Navamī ★ |
| वैशाखः | vaiśākhaḥ | Apr – May | वसन्तः | Akṣaya Tṛtīyā, Buddha Pūrṇimā |
| ज्येष्ठः | jyeṣṭhaḥ | May – Jun | ग्रीष्मः | Vaṭa Pūrṇimā |
| आषाढः | āṣāḍhaḥ | Jun – Jul | ग्रीष्मः | Ratha Yātrā, Guru Pūrṇimā |
| श्रावणः | śrāvaṇaḥ | Jul – Aug | वर्षाः | Rakṣābandhana ★ |
| भाद्रपदः | bhādrapadaḥ | Aug – Sep | वर्षाः | Gaṇeśa Caturthī ★, Kṛṣṇa Janmāṣṭamī ★ (Śrāvaṇa in some calendars), Oṇam ★ nearby |
| आश्विनः | āśvinaḥ | Sep – Oct | शरत् | Navarātri ★, Vijayadaśamī ★ |
| कार्तिकः | kārtikaḥ | Oct – Nov | शरत् | Dīpāvalī ★ |
| मार्गशीर्षः | mārgaśīrṣaḥ | Nov – Dec | हेमन्तः | Gītā Jayantī |
| पौषः | pauṣaḥ | Dec – Jan | हेमन्तः | Makara Saṅkrānti ★ (about 14 Jan) |
| माघः | māghaḥ | Jan – Feb | शिशिरः | Vasanta Pañcamī |
| फाल्गुनः | phālgunaḥ | Feb – Mar | शिशिरः | Mahāśivarātri ★, Holi ★ |

## Solar (rāśi) months · सौरमासाः

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| मेषः<br>meṣaḥ | वृषभः<br>vṛṣabhaḥ | मिथुनम्<br>mithunam | कर्कटः<br>karkaṭaḥ | सिंहः<br>siṃhaḥ | कन्या<br>kanyā |
| तुला<br>tulā | वृश्चिकः<br>vṛścikaḥ | धनुः<br>dhanuḥ | मकरः<br>makaraḥ | कुम्भः<br>kumbhaḥ | मीनः<br>mīnaḥ |

A solar month begins when the sun enters a rāśi: मेषः from about mid-April, मकरः from about 14 January (Makara Saṅkrānti).

## Exercise · मासाः

1. Dīpāvalī falls in _____ .
2. The month after चैत्रः is _____ .
3. Rakṣābandhana is in _____ , in the ṛtu _____ .
4. The sun enters _____ on Makara Saṅkrānti.

# Mixed quiz · मिश्र-प्रश्नाः

## A. Which festival does each word belong to?

1. मोदकः → _____
2. तिलगुडम् → _____
3. शमीवृक्षः → _____
4. रङ्गवल्ली → _____
5. पुष्परङ्गवल्ली (pookkalam) → _____
6. रक्षा → _____
7. होलिका → _____
8. पतङ्गः → _____
9. मूषकः → _____
10. दीपः → _____
11. नवरात्रिः → _____
12. महाबलिः → _____
13. वेणुः → _____
14. बिल्वपत्रम् → _____
15. अयोध्या → _____
16. रावणदहनम् → _____

## B. Finish the line

17. वक्रतुण्ड महाकाय _____
18. तमसो मा _____
19. सर्वे भवन्तु _____

# Festival greetings · उत्सव-शुभाशयाः

| Sanskrit | Sound | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| दीपावलीशुभाशयाः | dīpāvalīśubhāśayāḥ | Happy Dīpāvalī! |
| गणेशचतुर्थीशुभाशयाः | gaṇeśacaturthīśubhāśayāḥ | Happy Gaṇeśa Caturthī! |
| विजयदशमीशुभाशयाः | vijayadaśamīśubhāśayāḥ | Happy Vijayadaśamī! |
| ओणम्-शुभाशयाः | oṇam-śubhāśayāḥ | Happy Oṇam! |
| मकरसङ्क्रान्तिशुभाशयाः | makarasaṅkrāntiśubhāśayāḥ | Happy Makara Saṅkrānti! |
| होलिकोत्सवशुभाशयाः | holikotsavaśubhāśayāḥ | Happy Holi! |
| रक्षाबन्धनशुभाशयाः | rakṣābandhanaśubhāśayāḥ | Happy Rakṣābandhana! |
| कृष्णजन्माष्टमीशुभाशयाः | kṛṣṇajanmāṣṭamīśubhāśayāḥ | Happy Janmāṣṭamī! |
| रामनवमीशुभाशयाः | rāmanavamīśubhāśayāḥ | Happy Rāma Navamī! |
| महाशिवरात्रिशुभाशयाः | mahāśivarātriśubhāśayāḥ | Happy Mahāśivarātri! |
| तिलगुडं गृहाण, मधुरं वद। | tilaguḍaṃ gṛhāṇa, madhuraṃ vada | Take sesame-jaggery, speak sweetly. |
| भवते / भवत्यै शुभाशयाः। | bhavate / bhavatyai śubhāśayāḥ | Best wishes to you (to a man / a woman). |

## Make a greeting card

To / प्रति: _____

_____ शुभाशयाः!

From / इति: _____

# Answer key · उत्तराणि (1)

## Festival exercises (1-5 on each śloka page)

| | |
|---|---|
| **Dīpāvalī** | 1 lamp · 2 oil · 3 rangoli (coloured floor design) · 4 दीपावली · 5 अमावास्या |
| **Gaṇeśa Caturthī** | 1 Gaṇeśa · 2 modaka (sweet dumpling) · 3 the big-bellied one · 4 गणपतिः · 5 विसर्जनम् |
| **Navarātri** | 1 nine nights · 2 Sarasvatī · 3 fasting · 4 दुर्गा · 5 गरबा |
| **Dasarā · Vijayadaśamī** | 1 the tenth day of victory · 2 Rāvaṇa · 3 worship of tools and weapons · 4 दशहरा · 5 विद्यारम्भः |
| **Oṇam** | 1 Śravaṇa star (Thiruvonam day) · 2 flower carpet (Malayalam: pookkalam) · 3 boat race (Malayalam: vallam kali) · 4 महाबलिः · 5 केरलम् |
| **Makara Saṅkrānti** | 1 sun entering Makara · 2 sesame · 3 kite · 4 सूर्यः · 5 धान्यम् |
| **Holi** | 1 Holikā (the bonfire night) · 2 month of Phālguna · 3 water · 4 प्रह्लादः · 5 मित्रम् |
| **Mahāśivarātri** | 1 Śiva · 2 bilva leaf · 3 small hand drum · 4 रात्रिः · 5 जागरणम् |
| **Rakṣābandhana** | 1 tying of the protective thread · 2 brother · 3 month of Śrāvaṇa · 4 रक्षा · 5 उपहारः |
| **Rāma Navamī** | 1 Rāma · 2 King Daśaratha · 3 Lakṣmaṇa · 4 नवमी · 5 रामायणम् |
| **Kṛṣṇa Janmāṣṭamī** | 1 Kṛṣṇa · 2 flute · 3 fresh butter · 4 जन्माष्टमी · 5 मध्यरात्रिः |

# Answer key · उत्तराणि (2)

## Mixed quiz A

1. Gaṇeśa Caturthī
2. Makara Saṅkrānti
3. Vijayadaśamī
4. Dīpāvalī
5. Oṇam
6. Rakṣābandhana
7. Holi
8. Makara Saṅkrānti
9. Gaṇeśa Caturthī
10. Dīpāvalī
11. Navarātri
12. Oṇam
13. Kṛṣṇa Janmāṣṭamī
14. Mahāśivarātri
15. Rāma Navamī
16. Vijayadaśamī

## Adornment: label the picture

1 बिन्दुः · 2 कुण्डलम् · 3 हारः · 4 कङ्कणम् · 5 नूपुरम् · 6 मेखला · 7 नासाभरणम् · 8 कज्जलम् · 9 वेणी · 10 शाटी · 11 कञ्चुकः · 12 मेन्धिका

Write the word: तोरणम् · पुष्पमाला · नूपुरम्

## Seasons exercise

1. वर्षाः (varṣāḥ)
2. शरत् (śarat)
3. वसन्तः (vasantaḥ)
4. शिशिरः (śiśiraḥ); हेमन्तः is also accepted
5. वसन्तः, ग्रीष्मः, वर्षाः, शरत्, हेमन्तः, शिशिरः

## Months exercise

1. कार्तिकः (kārtikaḥ)
2. वैशाखः (vaiśākhaḥ)
3. श्रावणः · वर्षाः
4. मकरः (makaraḥ)

## Mixed quiz B

17. सूर्यकोटिसमप्रभ
18. ज्योतिर्गमय
19. सुखिनः

> शोभनम्! Well done! · उत्सवाः आनन्ददायकाः। (Festivals bring joy.)